Apple Inc.

AAPL NASDAQ

Hold	$341.70 ▲ 0.21%	12M Price Target	52-Week Range	Market Cap
		$365.00	$243.42 – $348.15	$4.99T

AAPL: Near Record Highs, But Insiders Are Cashing Out

WHAT HAPPENED

- AAPL is sitting at $341.70, basically kissing its 52-week high ($348) — the stock is up about 40% off the lows and has essentially gone vertical. No fresh news or filings overnight, so this is pure momentum/positioning, likely tied to the iPhone cycle running hotter than expected and the broader "mega-cap tech is safe" trade.
- Here's the yellow flag though: Tim Cook dumped ~$50M in stock on October 2nd across three tranches, and the GC/Government Affairs chief also sold. When insiders sell near highs, it doesn't mean the stock crashes — but it tells you the people with the best info aren't seeing $400 anytime soon.

WHY IT MATTERS

The setup here is a classic "melt-up with warning signs." Options flow is loaded with calls (580K vs 294K puts), but the unusual activity shows huge put buying at $342.50 and $345 strikes — meaning somebody with real money is paying up for downside protection right at current levels. Translation: smart money is hedging, not chasing. Combine that with cluster insider selling and a stock at 94% of its 52-week range, and the risk/reward for NEW money gets uglier — you're buying what insiders are selling. If you already own it, you're fine; if you're trying to initiate, patience pays here.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big political overhang is the Trump administration's China tariff posture — Apple still assembles the majority of iPhones in China and Vietnam, and any escalation in the trade talks (which have been on-and-off all year) directly compresses gross margins. On the positive side, Apple has been fast-tracking the India manufacturing shift and got carve-outs on some semiconductor tariffs, which is why the stock hasn't been punished. Also watch the DOJ antitrust case on the App Store — a forced opening of the walled garden would hit Services revenue (their highest-margin business at ~70% gross margin), and that case is grinding through appeals right now.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

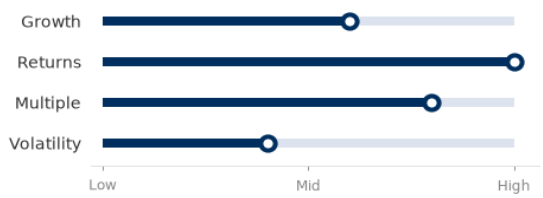
At ~$5 trillion market cap and roughly 43x forward earnings, you're paying $43 for every $1 of profit Apple will make next year — that's expensive for a company growing revenue in the high single digits. For context, the S&P 500 trades around 22x, so AAPL is at nearly double the market multiple. The bull case says Services growth and AI-driven iPhone upgrades justify it; the bear case says you're paying a growth multiple for a mature hardware company, and multiples don't expand forever.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	**$341.70**
12M Price Target	**$365.00**
Upside / (Downside)	**+6.8%**
Market Cap	**$4.99T**
FY2026E Revenue	**$445M**
FY2027E Revenue	**$478M**
FY2026E EPS	**$7.85**
FY2027E EPS	**$8.70**
Fwd P/E	**43.5x**

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

AAPL — Apple Inc. | October 13, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	**$360.00**	$345.00	**$320.00**
6 Months	**$390.00**	$360.00	**$300.00**
1 Year	**$420.00**	$365.00	**$285.00**
2 Years	**$500.00**	$400.00	**$260.00**
5 Years	**$700.00**	$500.00	**$300.00**
10 Years	**$1100.00**	$750.00	**$350.00**

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+1.67% today, +5.27% on the week) is on fire — likely tied to Middle East tensions and OPEC supply chatter. Communication Services also strong, which is a tell that mega-cap tech is still the preferred hiding spot.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Staples barely moving — classic sign the market has risk appetite and isn't playing defense.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing into mega-cap tech and energy simultaneously, which is unusual — usually one or the other. That tells me institutions are barbelling: owning growth (AAPL, Comm Svcs) while hedging with real-asset exposure (Energy) in case inflation picks back up.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the AAPL thesis but want more torque, the semi names that supply Apple (TSM, QCOM, AVGO) move harder on the same iPhone cycle news with less of the regulatory baggage.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Enterprise AI monetization is actually showing up in Azure numbers — the "AI pays off" story is working better here than at Apple.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Gemini momentum plus the ad business is holding up; the market is rewarding companies that can show AI revenue, not just AI features.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is participating in the mega-cap tech rally but lagging the names that have a clearer AI monetization story. That's the market telling you Apple is being valued as a quality compounder, not as an AI winner — which caps the upside unless they deliver a real AI product moment.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the business long-term, but buying at 94% of the 52-week range while Cook is selling isn't my favorite setup.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% as a core holding — this is a "sleep well at night" name, not a swing-for-the-fences bet.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for a pullback to $315-325, which is where the stock would likely retrace on any tariff headline or market wobble.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm watching is the iPhone 18 cycle and whether Apple Intelligence actually gets better.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Services growth slows below 8% YoY, or if a major antitrust ruling forces App Store changes, the thesis cracks and I'd trim.

HEDGING: Simplest move — buy a put option at the $320 strike expiring 6 months out. Think of it like insurance: you pay a small premium, and if the stock drops hard, your puts gain value and offset the loss on your shares.

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